IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 38

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	Ashford	
2	travel diary	
3	spine	
4	cloth	
5	gold	
6	22	22nd, twenty-second
7	marbled paper	
8	protective box	
9	six weeks	6 weeks
10	courier	insured courier
11	B	
12	G	
13	D	
14	H	
15	A	
16	F	
17	C	
18	A	
19	B	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	C	
21	pressure sensor	
22	three	3
23	easy	
24	45	forty-five
25	randomised	
26	B	
27	C	
28	A	
29	D	
30	A	
31	mesopause	
32	ice crystals	
33	dust particles	
34	cold	
35	twilight	
36	northern	
37	B	
38	C	
39	A	
40	B	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - everyday social dialogue

Calum Beck	This is Tyne Book Conservation. Before I quote for the diary, I need its ownership details, structural condition and the finish you want to preserve. Let me open a conservation record. What surname should appear on the quotation?
Leonie Ashford	My surname is Ashford, A-S-H-F-O-R-D. The note on the parcel says Ashton, which is incorrect.
Calum Beck	Could you describe the volume itself? Its purpose affects how much handling the new binding must withstand.
Leonie Ashford	It is a family travel diary kept by my grandmother, not a published novel or an official record. I still read the diary with my children, so I want it usable rather than polished until it looks new.

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Calum Beck	That means we will preserve stable marks of use while repairing only what prevents safe handling.
Leonie Ashford	I will list the loose photograph and fold-out maps on a separate sheet before packing the volume flat.
Calum Beck	Good. We photograph every insert on arrival and return any removed fragments in a labelled envelope. Are any pages missing, or is the main damage in the structure that holds the sections together?
Leonie Ashford	The pages are complete, but the spine is loose and two sewn sections lift when the book is opened. Several pencilled routes cross the fold-out maps, and those marks matter more to us than perfect flatness.
Calum Beck	Then the maps will be supported at their existing folds rather than pressed into a new shape.
Leonie Ashford	Could the original thread be kept if some sections remain sound?
Calum Beck	Yes, the binder replaces sewing only where weakness makes reuse unsafe. Which covering material suits the way your family plans to use the book?
Leonie Ashford	Leather was attractive but costly; I would prefer durable green cloth that can be handled regularly.
Calum Beck	For the spine title, would you prefer the modern silver sample or the warmer traditional finish?
Leonie Ashford	Please use gold lettering on the spine. Silver was shown in the sample, but it looked too modern.
Calum Beck	Which of the two collection appointments in your email can you accept?
Leonie Ashford	Collection can take place on the twenty-second of April; the nineteenth is too early because I am away.
Calum Beck	Inside the covers, is there an original feature that matters especially to the family?
Leonie Ashford	The original marbled paper inside the covers should be retained if it can be lifted safely. One page still carries a pressed fern; should I remove it before the collection?
Calum Beck	Leave it where it is, but place clean paper on either side so the collection team does not dislodge it during insured transport to the workshop.
Leonie Ashford	Because the diary moves between relatives, what extra item would protect it during transport?
Calum Beck	Because the diary travels between relatives, I recommend a protective box rather than a display stand.
Leonie Ashford	How long should I allow for the work, including pressing and drying?
Calum Beck	Allow six weeks from approval of the written quotation; drying and pressing account for much of that time.
Leonie Ashford	And once it is finished, how will the book be returned to me?
Calum Beck	We will return it by insured courier. Collection in person remains possible, but it is not the arrangement selected. I will now prepare the provisional quotation, pricing the structural repair, new covering and storage box as separate decisions for you to review carefully online.

Part 2 - everyday social monologue

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Tessa Rowntree	Welcome across the bridge to West Beck Mill. The plan separates two floors, so I will orient you before describing demonstrations and visitor facilities.
Tessa Rowntree	After the entrance bridge, the ticket desk is tucked below the wheel-room wall immediately inside the courtyard; the counter farther across the court is not for admission.
Tessa Rowntree	The map has two levels: solid lines show the ground floor, while the shaded inset represents the upper gallery.
Tessa Rowntree	Children on the trail collect stamps at fixed public stations, not in staff-only machinery rooms.
Tessa Rowntree	The wheel gallery occupies the long western room beside the mill channel, between the sluice window and the stone floor.
Tessa Rowntree	The bridge entrance crosses the mill stream into the courtyard; visitors should not follow the delivery lane beside the grain store.
Tessa Rowntree	The picnic lawn has benches and a drinking-water tap, but food cannot be carried back into the mill because of dust and pest controls.
Tessa Rowntree	The flour room is in the upper-floor inset, directly above the stone floor and reached by the narrow internal stair.
Tessa Rowntree	A narrow stair reaches the upper floor, but the ramp route ends at a platform with a clear view of the wheel and gearing.
Tessa Rowntree	Visitors leaving through the east gate may re-enter with their ticket until closing, except during a scheduled delivery.
Tessa Rowntree	The accessible viewing platform is at the end of the courtyard ramp, overlooking the wheel through the glazed western wall.
Tessa Rowntree	Staff alone operate the sluice and machinery, and a bell sounds before any demonstration begins.
Tessa Rowntree	The wheel turns only when water level and staff supervision permit, so advertised demonstrations may use the gearing without full water power.
Tessa Rowntree	The picnic lawn lies beyond the east gate, across the riverside path and well away from the delivery lane.
Tessa Rowntree	The flour room may be dusty, so visitors with breathing concerns can watch the same explanation on a screen downstairs.
Tessa Rowntree	Please silence your phones during the mill talk because I rely on hearing changes in the machinery.
Tessa Rowntree	The bread shop faces into the courtyard beside the visitor exit, opposite the lower end of the ramp.
Tessa Rowntree	The east gate leads directly to the lawn and riverside path, but it is closed during deliveries.
Tessa Rowntree	The stone floor has an uneven threshold; a contrasting strip marks it, but running and backward photography remain discouraged.
Tessa Rowntree	During a machinery demonstration, remain behind the marked rail even if the wheel appears to have stopped.

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Tessa Rowntree	The mill stream runs along the western wall and feeds the wheel through a controlled channel that visitors can see from behind glazing.
Tessa Rowntree	School groups store coats in the courtyard room before climbing upstairs, keeping stair handrails and turning spaces clear.
Tessa Rowntree	The family trail begins at the ticket desk, not upstairs where the activity sheets are returned.
Tessa Rowntree	On the stone floor, staff demonstrate milling with the machinery isolated; the public never handles a moving belt or gear.
Tessa Rowntree	The bread shop sells flour milled on site only when a batch has passed the mill's normal food checks.
Tessa Rowntree	There is a short introduction at eleven, but the main mill talk begins at half past twelve.
Tessa Rowntree	The upper gallery explains grain cleaning and storage, whereas actual flour packing takes place in a closed workroom.
Tessa Rowntree	At closing time, the east gate locks first and all remaining visitors leave across the entrance bridge.
Tessa Rowntree	Bread tasting is open to everyone, whereas the stone-dressing demonstration needs advance booking because space is limited.
Tessa Rowntree	A lift is not available in the historic building, so the platform and video link provide the accessible alternative to the narrow stair.
Tessa Rowntree	The mill bell will announce each activity; visitors can use the plan to move between public rooms without entering operational areas.

Part 3 - educational or training discussion

Professor Iona Kerr	Our package-opening pilot raised several design questions. We should decide exactly what to measure, how to order the trials and who prepares each element.
Soraya Linn	We should place a pressure sensor under the thumb area; a stopwatch alone cannot show how grip force changes.
Professor Iona Kerr	The project compares package designs, not the strength or competence of individual users.
Soraya Linn	Dummy tablets are large enough to create realistic resistance but contain no active ingredient and are collected after every trial.
Ben Okoro	Each trial begins only after the participant rests both hands on the table, giving the equipment a stable zero reading.
Ben Okoro	Three prototypes are enough for comparison without making the session tiring.
Soraya Linn	An opening may succeed slowly, fail completely, or succeed only after an incorrect first action; these outcomes must be recorded separately.
Ben Okoro	A rest interval between prototypes reduces fatigue, while the random order prevents the same design always appearing after the break.

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Professor Iona Kerr	If a sensor trace is lost, the practical outcome remains documented but that attempt is excluded from the force comparison.
Professor Iona Kerr	Avoid calling any package easy, because that wording could influence both confidence and persistence.
Ben Okoro	The students decide to measure grip position as well as force because two participants can apply similar force at different points.
Professor Iona Kerr	The consent sheet explains that the package, not the participant, is under evaluation and that unsuccessful opening is valuable data.
Soraya Linn	Professor Kerr warns against averaging every attempt immediately because distinct error types may disappear inside one mean value.
Soraya Linn	Let us define a failed attempt as no successful opening after forty-five seconds, not thirty.
Professor Iona Kerr	All prototypes will contain harmless dummy tablets so weight and sound feel realistic without involving medication.
Soraya Linn	After each attempt, participants describe where they expected the package to open before seeing the next design.
Ben Okoro	I will schedule older and younger volunteers across the day instead of placing one group entirely in the morning.
Ben Okoro	Prototype order must be randomised for each participant so practice or fatigue does not favour one design.
Soraya Linn	A pilot with a small mixed-age group will test the clarity of the task before formal recruitment begins.
Ben Okoro	Could we measure hand size? I realise we should add it only if it connects to a stated analysis question.
Professor Iona Kerr	Soraya proposes a short neutral demonstration showing the task boundary without revealing where any prototype is meant to open.
Professor Iona Kerr	Ben will recruit the older volunteers through the community design panel.
Ben Okoro	Participants may stop for discomfort at any point, and that choice will not be coded as an opening failure.
Professor Iona Kerr	Soraya will mark the starting grip only after the participant has naturally picked up the pack, avoiding coached placement.
Soraya Linn	The final report will describe performance ranges and observed strategies rather than ranking the prototypes on a single headline score.
Soraya Linn	Professor Kerr will supervise calibration of the force equipment before the pilot.
Professor Iona Kerr	Prototype one has a broad tab, prototype two changes the blister backing, and prototype three combines a raised corner with clearer directional marking.
Soraya Linn	Professor Kerr requires a stop rule if a repeated push causes discomfort, even when the forty-five-second window has not ended.
Ben Okoro	Soraya will prepare the illustrated instructions and remove evaluative words from the captions.

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Soraya Linn	Opening force is sampled continuously, so the team can distinguish one sharp push from several weaker attempts.
Ben Okoro	The overhead camera captures hand movement without recording faces, and files are assigned study codes before analysis.
Professor Iona Kerr	The lab assistant will code opening errors from the overhead recordings using the agreed categories.
Ben Okoro	Grip position will be coded from video using zones printed on a transparent overlay, avoiding vague descriptions such as near the edge.
Professor Iona Kerr	A successful opening followed by spilled tablets receives a different error code from an opening that never releases the pocket.
Soraya Linn	I will compare successful and failed attempts because I am already structuring the analysis table.
Professor Iona Kerr	The researchers will not ask participants to use their usual medicine because familiarity with a brand could bias the strategy selected.
Soraya Linn	The students agree to record whether participants rotate the pack, since orientation may explain force readings that otherwise appear inconsistent.
Ben Okoro	The package trial can proceed once the sensor, random order and error categories survive a small pilot with clearly informed volunteers.

Part 4 - academic monologue

Professor Maeve Haldane	Today I will walk you through a cloud-observation case from our methods course. The images and readings belong to the exercise, so concentrate on how the record is analysed.
Professor Maeve Haldane	In the opening case notes, the cloud layer sits near the mesopause, much higher than the layer assigned to ordinary weather.
Professor Maeve Haldane	In those notes, we gloss noctilucent as night-shining, although our display is not visible throughout the night or from every latitude.
Professor Maeve Haldane	The case mechanism allows sunlight to split methane into water molecules high above, adding water vapour to the mesosphere.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Our summer profile sets an exceptionally cold, wet mesopause where the high-altitude ice clouds can form.
Professor Maeve Haldane	For this lecture, one exceptional summer can motivate study, but it cannot establish a long-term trend by itself across different observation sites and methods.
Professor Maeve Haldane	They consist mainly of tiny ice crystals rather than droplets of liquid water.
Professor Maeve Haldane	At roughly the edge of space, pressure is extremely low and the available water vapour is sparse.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Water vapour then freezes around tiny specks of meteor dust in the upper layer.
Professor Maeve Haldane	The crystals persist only while water, nuclei and sufficiently low temperature coincide; a change in any component can weaken the display.

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Professor Maeve Haldane	In the second section of the case, water molecules freeze around minute dust particles, which provide nuclei for crystal growth.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Seasonal circulation can cool the summer mesopause even while temperatures near the ground are comparatively warm.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Here, the mesosphere may be coldest during summer, unlike the seasonal pattern set at ground level.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Bright lower clouds may hide the phenomenon completely even when favourable conditions exist much higher above them.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Paradoxically, the upper atmosphere must be unusually cold, a condition most common there during summer.
Professor Maeve Haldane	The geometry of illumination matters: the Sun lies below the observer’s horizon while remaining above the horizon of the high cloud layer.
Professor Maeve Haldane	For our observing exercise, estimate elevation against a familiar star or fixed horizon landmark, then record that chosen method beside the image.
Professor Maeve Haldane	They are usually noticed during twilight, when the ground is dark but sunlight still reaches the high layer.
Professor Maeve Haldane	For our comparison, use ground photographs for local detail and orbital records for wider coverage, then document why the two records serve different purposes.
Professor Maeve Haldane	During twilight, the observer stands in darkness while high-altitude crystals still receive rays that pass over Earth’s curved horizon.
Professor Maeve Haldane	The next section examines the image record. Wave-like bands can reveal motion in the upper layer, but a photograph gives no direct temperature measurement.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Imagine a time-lapse in which bands drift and reform; one still image would then be a poor map of the whole display.
Professor Maeve Haldane	At northern mid-latitudes, displays often appear low above the northern horizon before extending higher.
Professor Maeve Haldane	My caution is that more reports may reflect physical change, reporting effort, or both.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Ground stations provide local timing, while the Aster-3 orbital record gives broader coverage from another angle.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Some displays extend towards the zenith, but low northern arcs are more typical at the latitude considered in the lecture.
Professor Maeve Haldane	A low cloud would be in Earth’s shadow at that time; the glowing material must be high enough to remain sunlit.
Professor Maeve Haldane	In this lecture, separate questions about formation, visibility and reporting before interpreting the record.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Changes in water vapour and upper-atmosphere temperature can both influence formation, which complicates single-driver explanations.
Professor Maeve Haldane	The composite combines data from several passes by Aster-3.

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Professor Maeve Haldane	We now compare coverage in the course dataset: repeated orbital passes include regions where the ground network has few observers.
Professor Maeve Haldane	For this analysis, require comparable observations across several seasons and document where and how each observation was made before drawing any claim about change.
Professor Maeve Haldane	When comparing old and new reports, I would record changes in cameras and reporting tools.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Ground reports add time and place; coverage varies with assigned observers and clear-sky windows.
Professor Maeve Haldane	In the archive exercise, observation methods change over time, including camera sensitivity, so more reports do not automatically mean more cloud occurrence.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Although ordinary clouds occupy the lower atmosphere, noctilucent clouds occur in a remote region where direct sampling is difficult.
Professor Maeve Haldane	For that exercise, record the time, location, camera settings and cloud direction in one consistent template before comparing entries.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Linking cloud occurrence to long-term atmospheric change requires a mechanism, not merely a parallel upward trend in observations.
Professor Maeve Haldane	The most useful interpretation combines ground photographs, satellite records and atmospheric measurements.
Professor Maeve Haldane	The crystals are extremely small, allowing them to scatter sunlight effectively while remaining almost invisible against a bright daytime sky.
Professor Maeve Haldane	For the final check, each group tests one proposed explanation for visibility against the same set of photographs.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Group the observations by latitude and report whether the pattern changes; do not assume in advance that it will.
Professor Maeve Haldane	Noctilucent-cloud records become persuasive only when formation conditions, lighting geometry and changing observation systems are analysed together.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	iii	
2	vi	
3	i	
4	viii	
5	iv	
6	vii	
7	ii	
8	wood	
9	stock	
10	grain	
11	cuts	notches
12	officials	
13	paper	paper records
14	C	
15	A	
16	A	
17	B	
18	C	
19	tree-base crevices	tree-base hollows, base hollow, hollow, base cavity, cavity
20	wood	
21	entrance	
22	ventilation	
23	FALSE	
24	FALSE	
25	NOT GIVEN	
26	TRUE	
27	NO	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
28	NO	
29	NO	
30	YES	
31	NO	
32	inventory	
33	inspections	reviews
34	contributions	
35	operating	
36	probability	
37	B	
38	C	
39	D	
40	A	

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